



Khalifa Nikzad

Backend Software Engineer |
Full-Stack Developer

Contact

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- Vienna, Austria

Technical Skills

Programming Languages

Python, PHP, JavaScript, SQL

Backend

FastAPI, Django, Laravel, RESTful APIs

Frontend

HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, Bootstrap, jQuery, React

Databases

MySQL, MongoDB

DevOps & Cloud

Docker, Kubernetes, Git, Linux, Google Cloud Platform (GCP)

Software Engineering

Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), Design Patterns, MVC Architecture, Agile/Scrum

Core Competencies

Backend Development, System Design, Database Design, API Development, Workflow Automation, Requirements Analysis

Education

MSc Computer Science

University of Vienna (2024 - Present)

BSc Computer Science

Herat University (2012 - 2015)

Languages

Persian: Native
English: C1
German: A2

Professional Summary

Backend Software Engineer with **8+ years** of professional experience and an M.Sc. in Computer Science (thesis in progress) at the University of Vienna. Experienced in developing scalable **backend systems**, **REST APIs**, and **full-stack** web applications using **Python (FastAPI, Django)**, **React**, **MySQL**, **MongoDB**, and **Docker**. Passionate about clean architecture and distributed systems.

Experience

Software Engineer

Norwegian Refugee Council (NRC) - Kabul, Afghanistan Aug 2022 – Dec 2023

- Developed a **Django/MySQL** web application to monitor project progress across multiple humanitarian projects within the NRC.
- Designed **Python-based ETL pipelines**, SQL queries, and database structures to consolidate and validate data from different sources.
- Automated** data validation and reporting workflows, improving the quality and consistency of data covering approximately **500,000 beneficiaries**.

Technologies: Python, Django, SQL, JavaScript, Bootstrap, jQuery, KoboToolbox

Software Engineer

OXFAM International NGOs - Kabul, Afghanistan Jan 2020 - Jul 2022

- Co-developed a **Django/MySQL-based** CFRM web application supporting **10-15** concurrent humanitarian projects.
- Led requirements analysis, database design, workflow design, and backend implementation.
- Developed **Python ETL pipelines and role-based workflows** to centralize beneficiary feedback and streamline complaint management.
- Contributed to improving beneficiary satisfaction with CFRM system from **3.7/5 to 4.4/5** by enhancing complaint tracking and follow-up processes.

Technologies: Python, Django, SQL, Git, JavaScript, Bootstrap, jQuery, KoboToolbox

Software Developer

ClikGlobal (Remote – USA) Oct 2018 – Oct 2019
(in partnership with PomTech, Afghanistan)

- Developed **Laravel-based** applications and business websites for U.S. clients, implementing **backend modules**, **RESTful APIs**, and **MySQL** databases.
- Built responsive web interfaces using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and Bootstrap.
- Worked in a **10+ developer** distributed team, following Git-based workflows, code reviews, Agile practices, testing, and technical documentation.

Technologies: PHP, Laravel, MySQL, Git | HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Bootstrap, jQuery, Ajax

Software Developer

Alfa Plus Inc - Kabul, Afghanistan Mar 2016 – Sep 2018

- Developed a University Management System with **Laravel**, supporting student enrolment, course registration, grading, and payment management.
- Built responsive web interfaces using HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, and JavaScript.
- Collaborated with the **development team** to implement new features, maintain existing modules, and improve application reliability.

Technologies: PHP, Laravel, MySQL, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Bootstrap, jQuery, Git

Featured Project

FactCheck – Customizable Comparison Logic Framework

University of Vienna March 2026 – June 2026

- Designed and developed a **Domain-Specific Language (DSL)** for customizable fact comparison using predefined functions and operators.
- Implemented an **Abstract Syntax Tree (AST)-based validation pipeline** with syntax, semantic, and safety validation.
- Built a secure **AST-based execution engine** supporting explainable results and confidence scoring without using **eval()**.
- Developed a full-stack application with **FastAPI**, **React**, **MongoDB**, and **Docker**, supporting formula versioning and execution history.

Technologies: Python, FastAPI, React, MongoDB, Docker, Git